

Blueprint: Pharmacy Near Me Web App

Vision

A location-aware web app that helps **residents and visitors in Nigeria** quickly find the nearest pharmacy and check available medications, reducing delays in accessing healthcare.

Core Features

1. Location Sync (Google Maps API)

- Auto-detect user location via GPS/IP.
- Show nearest pharmacies with distance and directions.

2. Pharmacy Database Integration

- Partner with **major pharmacy chains** (HealthPlus, MedPlus, Nett Pharmacy, etc.) that already use digital systems.
- For smaller pharmacies, allow **manual listing** and updates via a lightweight mobile dashboard.

3. Medication Availability

- Where stock systems exist → sync directly.
- Where not → pharmacies can update **popular medications list** (e.g., antimalarials, antibiotics, painkillers).
- AI prediction: Suggest likely availability based on **regional demand patterns** (e.g., malaria drugs in rainy season).

4. User Profiles

- Residents: Save preferred pharmacies.
- Visitors: Quick search without sign-up.
- Option for **language localization** (English, Pidgin, Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo).

5. Emergency Mode

- Highlight **24/7 pharmacies**.
 - Integrate with **nearest hospitals** for urgent care.
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Critical Inputs for Nigerian Context

- **Digital Divide:** Many pharmacies lack computerized inventory. Solution → phased rollout:

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- Phase 1: Location + contact info.
 - Phase 2: Manual updates of top 20 medications.
 - Phase 3: Full API integration with digital pharmacies.
 - **Regulatory Compliance:**
 - Partner with **Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (PCN)** for verified listings.
 - Prevent fake/illegal drug outlets from appearing.
 - **Trust & Adoption:**
 - Build credibility by **collaborating with NAFDAC** (National Agency for Food and Drug Administration and Control).
 - Include a **drug authenticity checker** (scan NAFDAC number).
 - **Infrastructure Challenges:**
 - Offline mode: Allow users to **download pharmacy maps** for their city.
 - SMS/USSD fallback for users without smartphones.
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Tech Stack

- **Frontend:** React (web), optional Flutter for mobile.
 - **Backend:** Node.js + Express.
 - **Database:** PostgreSQL for pharmacy listings.
 - **AI Layer:** Google Gemini for natural language queries (“Where can I get malaria drugs near Ikeja?”).
 - **Maps API:** Google Maps + OpenStreetMap (backup for cost savings).
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Rollout Strategy

1. **Pilot Cities:** Lagos, Abuja, Port Harcourt, Owerri.
 2. **Partnerships:** HealthPlus, MedPlus, local pharmacy associations.
 3. **Government Engagement:** PCN + NAFDAC endorsement.
 4. **Expansion:** Gradual onboarding of smaller pharmacies nationwide.
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Potential Add-Ons

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- **Telemedicine integration:** Connect users to doctors who can prescribe before purchase.
- **Delivery option:** Partner with logistics startups (Gokada, Kwik, Jumia Food).
- **Insurance tie-in:** Link with HMOs for covered medications.

✓ This blueprint balances **innovation with Nigerian realities**: limited digitization, regulatory needs, and infrastructure gaps.

Would you like me to **sketch a phased timeline (6–12 months)** showing how this app could realistically launch in Nigeria, from pilot to nationwide rollout?